

Role Play Scenarios

A guide for young people



Why Role Play Matters

Role playing is a fantastic way to practice real-life situations in a safe and supportive environment. It helps you to:

- **Build confidence:** By acting out different scenarios, you'll feel more prepared and less anxious when similar situations arise in real life.
- **Develop communication skills:** You'll learn how to express yourself clearly, listen effectively, and respond appropriately in various social contexts.
- **Practice problem-solving:** Role play allows you to explore different solutions to challenges and understand the consequences of your actions.
- **Improve empathy:** Stepping into someone else's shoes helps you understand different perspectives and feelings.
- **Gain self-awareness:** You can explore your own reactions and behaviours in a low-stakes setting.

Getting Started with Role Play

Choose a scenario that you find relevant or a little challenging. It could be something you've experienced, something you anticipate, or a situation you want to understand better.

Tips for effective role play:

- **Be open-minded:** Try to get into the character's mindset.
- **Be honest:** Respond in a way that feels natural to you, even if it's a bit awkward at first.
- **Don't be afraid to make mistakes:** This is a learning process, and mistakes are part of it.
- **Reflect afterwards:** Talk about what happened, what you learned, and how you felt.

You can role play by yourself, with a friend, a family member, or in a group.

If playing with others:

- **Assign roles:** Decide who will play each character.
- **Set the scene:** Briefly describe the situation.
- **Start the interaction:** Begin the conversation or action.
- **Pause and discuss:** It's often helpful to pause the role play to discuss strategies, feelings, or alternative actions.

Scenario Activities

Here are a few scenarios to get you started. Choose one that interests you and give it a go!

Scenario 1: Asking for help

Situation: You are struggling with a school assignment and have tried for a while to understand it on your own. You need to ask your teacher or a classmate for help.

Roles:

- You (the student needing help)
- Teacher/Classmate

Scenario 3: Saying 'no'

Situation: Someone is pressuring you to do something you're not comfortable with, like going somewhere you don't want to or doing something against the rules.

Roles:

- You
- The person pressuring you

Scenario 2: Resolving a disagreement

Situation: You and a friend have a different opinion about something important to both of you, and it's causing tension. You need to talk it through.

Roles:

- You
- Your friend

Scenario 4: Making a request

Situation: You want to borrow something from a family member or a friend, or you need to ask for a favour. You want to be polite and clear.

Roles:

- You
- Family member/Friend

You can adapt these scenarios or create your own. The more you practice, the more comfortable and skilled you'll become in navigating real-life situations.